

CREEK WHATCHAKNOW

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ENG317

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FADE IN

EXT. CITY STREET - NIGHT

A manhole cover in the middle of the street.
A police car drives over it.

INT. SEWER HIDEOUT - NIGHT

Two folding chairs lean against a brick wall.
Newspaper clippings and blueprints are taped on the wall.

RICHARD, a man in his early 20s, enters through a tunnel,
breathing heavily as he slumps into one of the chairs.

He adjusts his BLUE THIN-RIMMED GLASSES and wipes the sweat
from his forehead.

He rebuttons his jacket.

The sound of static emanates from his chest.

He flinches, wrapping his arms around his chest while
frantically looking around.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.)

You there, Richard?

Richard sighs.

RICHARD

Yes, and he could have easily been
here, too.

Maybe wait until I'm the one
speaking.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.)

We have eyes on him. He's about
five minutes from the entrance.

Maybe just listen to us "pigs"
instead.

Richard grips the arms of the chair, squirming in his seat.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Just get the dirt on him,
or don't,
and then, you know...

Richard moves his hand down to his pocket.
He grips his hand around the imprint of a SILVER HANDGUN in
his pocket.
He slips the handgun out of his pocket and sticks it in the
back of his jeans' waistband.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.) (CONT'D)
(chuckling)

Look alive, Dick!

We'll be at the big tunnel when
you're done.

The line goes dead, and the room is silent again.
Richard breathes in...
and out.

INT. SEWER HIDEOUT - CONTINUOUS

Richard perks up as he hears steps echoing from one of the
tunnels.

KEVIN, a man in his early 20s, enters the room out of breath,
his wife beater and cargo pants stained with sweat.
He leans over, heaving.
His RED GLASSES almost slip off his face before he pushes them
back on.

Richard gets up from the chair and approaches him.

RICHARD

What? Can't handle a little
exercise?

KEVIN

Fuck off.

Richard begins to wrap his arms around Kevin.
Kevin suddenly wraps his arms tightly around Richard.

KEVIN

I was so worried about you. I
thought they got you!

Kevin's hands get uncomfortably close to the wooden grip
sticking out of the back of Richard's pants.
Richard awkwardly wiggles out of Kevin's grasp.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

What? You afraid of getting a
boner or something?

RICHARD

Oh, you wish, with how macho you
are with that sailor's mouth.

Richard slumps back into his seat, scooching it so his back is
turned further away from Kevin.

KEVIN

Well shit! I think it's deserved.
We almost got caught!

You could have been locked up or
even worse.

Kevin pulls two BEER BOTTLES from a cooler placed against the
moist brick wall. He gives one to Richard.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

I think this calls for a
celebration!

Richard raises a bottle for a toast. Kevin grimaces as he
tepidly does the same.

INT. SEWER HIDEOUT - APPROACHING DAWN

A few empty beer bottles surround them as they are slumped in their chairs.

RICHARD

What's the worst thing you've ever done?

KEVIN

What for? Where did that come from?

RICHARD

Thinking about us. Whether we deserve a happy ending.

Tears begin to well in Richard's eyes.
Kevin lowers his head and puts a hand to his own cheek.

KEVIN

Don't even fucking talk like that, man.

We deserve a quiet, peaceful life.

Richard's expression doesn't change.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

Ok, if it'll help you feel better, I'll tell you the worst thing I've ever done.

Kevin leans forward.
Richard wipes the tears from his eyes.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

It was at Creek Whatchaknow.

RICHARD

The camp we went to as kids?

I already know all about that,
Kevin.

KEVIN

A camp for troubled youth.
Got sent there after I beat the
shit out of a kid who took my
glasses.

RICHARD

I was flunking my classes.
After dad died.

KEVIN

We didn't have a great start.
Especially with my dead dad jokes.

RICHARD

Or your dirty language.

KEVIN

But we were the only two kids with
glasses.

RICHARD

And not enough money to replace
them.

KEVIN

So we made it work.

Richard finally begins to crack a smile, Kevin following suit.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

I remember jumping into the creek
with you, yelling "Geronimo!"

Kevin holds up his hand, spreading his middle and ring fingers into a V shape.

KEVIN

Remember our signal?

RICHARD

Yes, I do.
Don't make me do it.

Kevin waves his signaling hand around.
Richard sighs and copies him.
They both chuckle.

KEVIN

We first used it when you broke
that old wood carving.

RICHARD

Oh god, yeah.
I was so terrified of
disappointing my mother.

KEVIN

And you didn't, because I took the
blame.

RICHARD

I still remember your cheeky smile
as you flashed that V as they
dragged you to the office.

KEVIN

That's where the twist comes in.
I was the one who broke the
carving.

RICHARD

But I saw it fall over!

KEVIN

I just propped it back up.
You were unlucky enough to have
knocked it down.

Richard holds a hand to his mouth, his brow furrowing slightly.

KEVIN

That was the worst thing I have
ever done.

Richard covers his face with his hands.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

I realize that sticking by your
side, no matter what, is just me
trying to make it up to you.

Kevin looks up at the ceiling.

KEVIN (CONT'D)

Heh, Creek Whatchaknow.

You always talked about wanting to
settle down there with me after
all this business was over.

Called that because when you think
about it, whatchaknow, you're
already there!

Richard pushes himself out of his chair. Pacing back and forth
while balling his hands into fists.

Kevin jumps up from his chair.

KEVIN

What's wrong?
I'm sorry for bringing that stuff
up.

Richard pulls the handgun from his waistband and aims it at Kevin. Kevin stands still, shocked, mouth agape.

RICHARD

I love you!

BANG.
BANG.
BANG.

Three shots whizz past Kevin and into the brick wall.
Kevin ducks and covers his ears.

Richard stands there holding the pistol, tears streaming down his cheeks. Kevin quickly snatches the gun from him.

KEVIN

What the fuck?
Why do you have a piece?

Richard responds with more sobbing.
His tears fog up his glasses.
A burst of static is heard from Richard's chest.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.)

Richard? How's it going down
there?

I heard shots.

Has he been dealt with?

Kevin slips the handgun into his pocket and stomps over to Richard. He sticks his hand down his jacket.

RICHARD

(to Kevin, sniffing)

No!

Please!

Richard's weak protest doesn't stop Kevin from ripping out a small radio from his jacket.

KEVIN

He'll be dealt with soon enough.

VOICE ON RADIO (V.O.)

What? Richard?

Kevin tosses the device into the river of sewage.

Kevin raises the gun and points it towards Richard.

KEVIN

I loved you too.

INT. SEWER TUNNEL - DAWN

Kevin drags Richard along by his collar down the tunnel. Richard stumbles as Kevin presses the gun barrel to the back of his head.

RICHARD

Please!
I know another way out.
You're walking right towards them.

KEVIN

Of course, you know exactly where they're waiting.

You backstabbing piece of shit.

Where's your "fuck the police" attitude now?

RICHARD

They told me I would avoid a life sentence if I killed you.

KEVIN

And you wouldn't take a life
sentence to save me?

Richard closes his eyes, grimaces, and shakes his head.

EXT. SEWER OUTPUT - CONTINUOUS

Multiple police officers surround the sewer's exit, guns
drawn.

INT. SEWER TUNNEL - DAWN

The tunnel gets brighter. Light is streaming from around the
corner.

RICHARD

All I wanted was a quiet life.
To live a peaceful life.

Kevin stops right before the corner and lets go of Richard,
pulling the gun from the back of his head.

KEVIN
(sarcastically)

And you will.

Kevin holds up the V signal and cracks a cheeky grin.

EXT. SEWER OUTPUT - DAWN

The officers stand, guns drawn. Only the sound of running
water can be heard.

Kevin runs out of the tunnel, arms held high, tightly gripping
the gun.

Richard is behind him, tripping before holding up his hand.

RICHARD

No!

KEVIN

Geroni-

Before he can finish, shots ring out, and Kevin is riddled with bullets.

The bullets also take off Richard's middle and ring fingers. His peace broken. He cups one hand over the bleeding stubs and curls up on the ground as the shots continue.

The shooting stops. Kevin's body collapses to the ground, his blood turning the creek red.

All that can be heard is the sound of running water and Richard's sobbing.

FADE OUT